

Employee Benefits & Insurance Guide

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Benefits Overview

This guide summarizes the core employee benefits offered by Northstar Digital Services Pvt. Ltd. It is a sample knowledge-base document intended to support questions about insurance, wellbeing, retirement, and reimbursements.

Eligibility normally begins on the employee's date of joining for regular full-time employees. Coverage for dependants varies by plan. The insurer's policy wording and applicable law govern if there is any conflict with this summary.

Employees must keep beneficiary and dependant information current in the HR portal. Changes caused by marriage, birth, adoption, or loss of other coverage should be reported within 30 calendar days.

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Group Health Insurance

The standard group medical plan provides an annual family floater sum insured of INR 5,00,000 for the employee, spouse or registered partner, and up to two dependent children. Parent coverage may be offered as an employee-paid optional add-on during the annual enrollment window.

Hospitalization is generally covered when medically necessary and subject to insurer terms. Pre-existing conditions are covered from day one under the current corporate plan, subject to policy exclusions and network rules.

For planned hospitalization, employees should request cashless pre-authorization when using a network hospital. For emergency hospitalization, the employee or family member should inform the third-party administrator as soon as reasonably possible.

Item	Standard rule
Family floater	INR 5,00,000
Pre-existing conditions	Covered from day one, subject to plan terms
Network hospital	Cashless pre-authorization recommended

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Term Life and Personal Accident

Eligible employees receive employer-paid group term life insurance equal to two times annual fixed pay, subject to a minimum cover of INR 10,00,000 and maximum cover of INR 1,00,00,000 under the current plan.

The group personal accident policy provides coverage for accidental death and specified permanent or temporary disabilities, subject to the insurer's schedule of benefits.

Employees should nominate beneficiaries in the HR portal. Claim notifications should be submitted promptly with the required supporting documents. People Operations can help the family coordinate with the insurer but cannot guarantee claim acceptance.

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Mental Health and Wellbeing

The Employee Assistance Program provides confidential counselling support through an external provider. Employees may access up to six counselling sessions per concern per policy year without charge under the standard program.

The wellness reimbursement provides up to INR 12,000 per financial year for eligible expenses such as gym membership, fitness classes, sports fees, meditation applications, or ergonomic wellness items, subject to receipt and category rules.

Managers should not request diagnostic details from employees using counselling or wellbeing benefits. Emergency mental-health situations should be directed to local emergency services or appropriate clinical care rather than handled solely through the EAP.

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Retirement, Gratuity and Leave Encashment

Provident Fund contributions are administered according to applicable law and the employee's eligible wage components. Employees should verify universal account number details and complete required declarations in the onboarding process.

Gratuity eligibility and payment follow applicable law. The benefit is normally payable after the legally required continuous-service period unless a statutory exception applies.

On separation, unused annual leave may be encashed where required by law or company policy. Sick leave and special leave are not normally encashable. Final settlement timing depends on payroll cut-off, asset clearance, statutory requirements, and completion of exit formalities.

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Claims, Support and Frequently Asked Questions

Medical claim documents should normally be submitted within the insurer's deadline. Typical reimbursement documents include claim form, discharge summary, itemized bills, prescriptions, investigation reports, and payment receipts.

FAQ: Is dental treatment covered? Routine dental treatment is not covered under the standard hospitalization plan unless required because of a covered accident or specifically included by the insurer. FAQ: Can I add parents mid-year? Parent enrollment is normally permitted only during the enrollment window or a qualifying life event if the plan allows it.

For support, employees should use the Benefits tile in the HR portal. Suggested metadata:
category=benefits; subcategory=insurance; policy_id=HR-BEN-2026; effective_date=2026-04-01;
audience=all-employees.